

Cooperative Education Linked to a Related Course (or Courses)*

This course consists of a learning experience connected to a community and a cooperative education curriculum that incorporates relevant expectations from the student's related course (or courses). Students will develop skills, knowledge, and habits of mind that will support them in their learning, including their education and career/life planning, at school and beyond, today and in the future. Within the context of their experience connected to a community, students will apply, extend, and refine skills and knowledge acquired in their related course or courses and will apply skills, knowledge, and habits of mind that will protect and promote their health, safety, and well-being. They will create and implement a learning plan that meets their particular interests and needs, reflect on their learning, and make connections between their experience in the community and other aspects of their lives.

Prerequisite: None

* A cooperative education course linked to a related course or courses does not have its own course code. It is recorded on the Provincial Report Card and the Ontario Student Transcript (OST) using the name(s) and course code(s) of the related course(s), with the term "(Co-op)" inserted after the course name. On the OST, the notation "C" is entered in the "Note" column.

A. PREPARING FOR THE EXPERIENCE: HEALTH AND SAFETY, WELL-BEING, AND INITIAL REQUIREMENTS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

Before the cooperative education experience, students will:

- A1. Health, Safety, and Well-Being:** demonstrate an understanding of legislation, practices, and behaviours related to health, safety, and well-being in connection with the cooperative education experience
- A2. Preparing and Planning for the Experience:** demonstrate an understanding of requirements and various considerations related to the cooperative education experience, in preparation for the experience

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Health, Safety, and Well-Being

Before the cooperative education experience, students will:

- A1.1** identify legislation, regulations, and policies related to health and safety, and explain how they apply to the cooperative education experience (e.g., the Occupational Health and Safety Act [OHSA] as it applies to (1) a worker's right to: know about any hazards to which they may be exposed, participate in the process of identifying and resolving health and safety concerns, and refuse work they believe is dangerous, and (2) the employer's responsibility to provide site- and equipment-specific Mandatory Worker Awareness Training; the Workplace Safety and Insurance Act [WSIA]; the Work Education Agreement [WEA] and the process of responding to workplace-related accidents and illnesses, including reporting injuries and providing support for recovery; the Workplace Hazardous Materials Information System [WHMIS] and regulations requiring employers to: label or identify controlled products, obtain material safety data sheets for controlled products, and educate workers; company policies on health screening, criminal record checks, workplace violence, workplace harassment, emergency procedures, and acceptable use of technology)

Teacher prompts: “Workers that are new to their job, including young workers, are three times more likely to be injured in the first month than at any other time. In addition to providing the Mandatory Worker Awareness Training, what

are the responsibilities of employers to ensure that the workplace supports the safety of workers?” “The definition of ‘worker’ under the Occupational Health and Safety Act (OHSA) includes unpaid secondary school students who are participating in a work experience authorized by their school board. What are these students’ roles and responsibilities, as workers, in helping to maintain a safe work environment? How will you determine your specific responsibilities with respect to safety?” “Is it advisable for you to have student accident insurance for your co-op experience? Why or why not?”

- A1.2** identify legislation, regulations, and policies, as well as various strategies and skills, that support well-being (including emotional safety) and the protection of human rights, and explain how they apply to the cooperative education experience (e.g., **legislation, regulations, policies:** Ontario’s Human Rights Code prohibits discrimination and harassment based on seventeen protected grounds, including race, creed, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, and gender expression; the Occupational Health and Safety Act [OHSA] sets out the rights and duties of all parties in the workplace to protect workers from health and safety hazards on the job; the Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act (FIPPA) protects confidentiality and the right to privacy; the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act (AODA) sets accessibility standards in order to achieve accessibility for people with disabilities;

the Employment Standards Act (ESA) requires that working conditions meet acceptable standards; strategies, skills: practices consistent with the acceptable use of technology; communication skills and strategies, including the appropriate way to respond to and report situations that make one feel uncomfortable or that are inappropriate; conflict resolution strategies; consulting with a trusted adult, such as a teacher, guidance counsellor, parent, or Elder – or in the case of adult students, a partner; using time management skills; setting priorities; appreciating differences among individuals)

Teacher prompts: “How might you respond when you witness a co-worker being bullied or harassed?” “During previous co-op or employment experiences, what did you observe that demonstrated respect for human rights within the organization?” “How we cope with stress can have a considerable effect on our mental health and can affect our safety and well-being in the workplace. What can you do to maintain a healthy school/life/work balance?” “How will you know which well-being and/or human rights issues you can address on your own, and which ones you need to refer to others?” “Who will you speak with to request religious accommodations during your cooperative education experience?” “In your cooperative education experience, you may feel that you are not receiving enough direction or the support you need to successfully complete your tasks. If you don’t get the support you need, you may find that your self-confidence and self-esteem suffer. You may start to blame yourself, or you may feel undervalued. In either case, you may need emotional support, and advice to help you deal with your feelings and the situation. What can you do to help yourself? Who can you turn to for help?” “Both emotional and physical safety are integral to a successful cooperative education experience. What are some characteristics of emotional safety? What are the conditions that might help you feel emotionally safe? What can you do to support your own emotional safety? What legislation protects emotional safety?”

A1.3 identify potential hazards and potentially hazardous situations that could arise in connection with the cooperative education experience, and describe the behaviours and practices that would help prevent and that assist in responding to such situations (e.g., *the use of required clothing and personal protective equipment [PPE] such as hardhats, safety glasses, ear protection, CSA-approved steel-toed boots for workers in manufacturing facilities; prompt attention to or reporting of faulty equipment, such as missing safety guards on an industrial mixer; clear procedures for*

incident/accident reporting; behaviours that assist in maintaining the safety of all workers at the workplace, such as immediately cleaning up spills to protect workers from potential slips and falls; online security and warnings against criminal or inappropriate use of the Internet, including cyberbullying)

Teacher prompts: “How can you recognize potential hazards at the site of, or related to, your cooperative education experience? What questions might you ask yourself and others when assessing a hazard and/or determining what to do to prevent incidents and keep safe?” “Resources and services for workers may differ, depending on the nature of the experience and the kinds of learning opportunities involved. What safety-related resources and services should be provided at your cooperative education placement?” “How do effective communication skills support safety?” “What are some actions you can take to promote your own and/or others’ safety during your cooperative education experience? What would you do if you felt it was necessary to advocate on your own and others’ behalf with respect to safety concerns?” “WHMIS is a regulation that applies to all workplaces where hazardous materials are stored or used. How are hazardous materials identified, and how can you determine what is needed to protect yourself when working with hazardous materials?”

A2. Preparing and Planning for the Experience

Before the cooperative education experience, students will:

A2.1 explore a variety of topics that relate to the cooperative education experience and the particular sector or area of focus of the experience (e.g., *local and global economic issues; emerging economies; labour market trends in the overall economy and in the particular sector or area of focus of the cooperative education experience; workplace/online culture; in the case of international cooperative education experiences: cultural values, beliefs, and local laws; corporate social responsibility initiatives; the appropriate use of social media in the workplace; organizational structures in the non-profit sector; the influence of Indigenous teaching practices and protocols in the education sector; globalization in the transportation sector; the role of unions in the construction sector; entrepreneurial opportunities in the energy sector; the impact of technology in the mining sector; postsecondary programs in the area of logistics; recruitment and employment strategies that support*

diversity and inclusion; the potential wage and benefit structure associated with various career pathways within the sector; types of employment, such as full-time employment, self-employment, and contract, seasonal, and part-time work) and explain how what they learned might contribute to success in their cooperative education experience and to their education and career/life planning

Teacher prompts: “What are some key questions to consider when preparing for an employment interview in the information, communication, and technology sector?” “What role might social media play in your job search? How is your ‘digital footprint’ relevant to your job search? What effect might your online history have on an employer’s opinion of you?” “What are some of the factors that influence the local and/or global economy, and how might these factors affect future employment opportunities?” “What programs are available to support your specific interests for postsecondary learning, and how can you access these programs?” “Reviewing career development information sites, visiting the organization for a face-to-face meeting, and researching labour market information are some ways of exploring education and career opportunities. What are the best strategies for learning about the sector/area of focus of your co-op experience?” “What are the professional or regulatory associations and various communities (local, global, virtual) in the field of work that interests you?”

- A2.2** describe their personal skills, interests, and strengths (e.g., *skills: technical, collaboration, numeracy, innovation, communication, time-management skills; knowledge of other languages; interests: working with children, outdoor experiences, sports, music, cooking, working with tools, travelling, social media, helping others, animal welfare; strengths: the ability to motivate and inspire others, resilience, perseverance, empathy, sense of humour, honesty, trustworthiness, flexibility*) and explain how these might contribute to success in their cooperative education experience

Teacher prompts: “One of the stages of the education and career/life planning process involves reflecting on the question, ‘Who am I?’. What are the characteristics that describe who you are? Consider your interests, values, skills, and strengths, including habits of mind that you feel are strengths.” “What are some of the factors that have shaped who you are and who you may become over time?” “How can you use information from your Individual Pathways Plan (IPP) and other tools to understand and develop your skills, interests, and

strengths?” “Employers consistently report that effective communication skills are important for every worker. What communication skills are relevant to your cooperative education experience in hairstyling?” “Some people have passionate interests – for example, in cooking, jewellery making, or video games or about social issues such as the environment, poverty, or LGBTQ issues – that can influence their decisions about postsecondary pathways. Based on your interests, what issues are important to you? How might your interests relate to your cooperative education experience?” “How would you describe your interview skills and strengths?” “Your virtual cooperative education experience will involve some web design. What are some of the skills you have developed in your Visual Arts courses that will give you a head start in learning about web design?” “You are interested in a co-op experience in the manufacturing sector, but you do not have any previous work experience in this area. During an interview with a prospective placement supervisor, how will you describe the skills and knowledge you have developed in your Manufacturing Technology course? How will you explain why that learning will be useful in the placement?”

- A2.3** identify the initial steps and requirements related to the cooperative education experience and demonstrate what they are doing to meet these requirements (e.g., *completing the application/interview process; determining details of the experience, such as hours of work, schedule, and breaks; developing and implementing a transportation plan for getting to their placement; getting the placement supervisor’s contact information; completing the Work Education Agreement; finding out about the equipment to be used, and about any certification or training requirements; reviewing attendance policies and codes of conduct; developing a business plan and/or project proposal; developing the Student’s Cooperative Education Learning Plan; in the case of an international cooperative education experience: completing appropriate health screening; asking questions to deepen their understanding of any school or board requirements for students taking a cooperative education course; anticipating challenges that might arise in connection with the experience and seeking clarification by asking questions*)

Teacher prompts: “The co-op experience directly involves the teacher, the placement supervisor, and you. However, others may also be affected by it. How might your participating in co-op affect your family members, friends, or

employers? What do you need to consider before you start your co-op experience?" "What do you think some of the initial requirements for your co-op experience will be? What will you need to arrange for before the experience starts? What will you need to bring with you to the placement? How will you confirm what is actually required?" "In order to ensure safety and to maximize learning, the employer and student are often required to read or complete, understand, and (where appropriate), sign certain agreements and other documents. How can you ensure that you understand the content of the documents? Why are some documents signed and others not? How do you determine which documents need to be signed and how long you need to keep the documents? What could be the consequences of breaching these signed agreements/documents?"

B. EXPERIENTIAL LEARNING AND TRANSFER OF SKILLS AND KNOWLEDGE

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Student's Cooperative Education Learning Plan:** develop, implement, and reflect on a learning plan, including learning related to health, safety, and well-being and to relevant expectations from the related course or courses, to maximize success in the cooperative education experience
- B2. Skills for the Future:** demonstrate the skills and knowledge developed or refined through the cooperative education experience, including skills and knowledge related to health, safety, and well-being and to relevant expectations from the related course or courses, and explain how they might use what they have learned in other aspects of their lives, now and in the future

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Student's Cooperative Education Learning Plan

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** develop their learning plan by determining short- and medium-term learning goals for the cooperative education experience (e.g., *short-term goal: to practise communicating information about their knowledge, skills, and interests for an interview to secure a cooperative education placement; to seek out and focus on aspects of the experience that offer opportunities to extend learning related to their selected related-course expectations; medium-term goal: to use effective time-management strategies to ensure that they achieve all course expectations; to learn more about being respectful of people's diversity, in terms of ethnocultural and/or socio-economic background, language, gender identity, and other areas of diversity; to learn about the ways in which social media can affect relationships; to refine skills outlined in the related-course expectations in order to support future involvement in an apprenticeship trade; to develop greater understanding of the mental health concerns that many young people experience and to learn about strategies that can be used to address them*) and longer-term education and career/life goals (e.g., *to use job search strategies to obtain a summer job; to save money for postsecondary education, training, or community living; to locate an employer who will sponsor*

them in a continued apprenticeship in carpentry; to obtain the advanced health and safety certification required to work in a child care setting; to volunteer at an organization that supports students in addressing mental health concerns; to develop and maintain a positive online presence, with a view to building an e-portfolio), and identify strategies to achieve these goals

Teacher prompts: "You and your teacher have examined the curriculum expectations of your related course [or: related courses] and are working together to identify the learning connected with those expectations that best supports your goals for the cooperative education experience. In addition to considering the best match between the skills and knowledge described in the expectations and the probable activities in the community experience, what are some of the other considerations that will guide the selection of related-course expectations?" "How would you describe a successful cooperative education experience? What do you need to learn by the end of the experience? What are some short- and/or medium-term learning goals that will help you succeed?" "How can you use what you have learned about yourself to help you set and achieve your goals? How can you use what you have learned in your related course to help you set and achieve your goals?" "Think about the people who might help you to meet your goal(s). In what ways could they support you? What is the appropriate way

to ask for their help?" "What resources are available that can help you learn about some of your career/life goals, such as saving and investing for your education?"

- B1.2** actively and safely participate in the cooperative education experience as they implement their learning plan (*e.g., show initiative – for instance, by offering to explore technological options that could enhance the organization's customer surveys; ask questions to clarify their understanding of tasks and of how to perform them safely; observe and demonstrate appropriate practices and procedures for safety and well-being and for environmental protection; where appropriate, be prepared with the right tools, equipment, and/or materials; work collaboratively as part of a team; offer suggestions about using social media and other electronic means of communication, accommodating a variety of languages and formats where possible*)

Teacher prompts: "Actively and intentionally observing others during your experience – seeing what they do and how they behave – can be a powerful learning strategy. How can you use observation to identify learning opportunities that align with your goals and to help increase your participation in your cooperative education experience?" "Actively participating in a cooperative education experience may be difficult at times. Some ways to support active participation include: taking time to understand the work culture; building relationships with other workers, clients, partners, and supervisors in a professional, productive manner that will help the organization or company achieve its goals; being receptive to new opportunities that may present themselves; and taking appropriate, calculated risks while always maintaining safety and well-being. What are some scenarios in which you can imagine applying these strategies? What are some other ways in which you can actively and safely participate in your co-op experience?" "One of your goals is to help increase the number of visits to the company's website. How might you access and engage with mentors to support the development of your ideas?" "How might selecting and applying appropriate tools, language skills, and strategies assist you in communicating and collaborating effectively in your cooperative education experience?" "How will you know which tasks can only be done by a certified or qualified professional, which tasks you can perform independently, and which ones require supervision or support?" "Which of the expectations from your related course involve learning that supports active and safe participation in your co-op experience?"

- B1.3** analyse and reflect on their learning plan, and revise it over time as appropriate

Teacher prompts: "During the cooperative education experience, regularly reviewing your goals and documenting and reflecting on your learning will help you see the progress you are making. Ask yourself what you have learned as you proceed through the experience, including what you have learned about yourself. How will you be able to tell that you've made progress in meeting your goals? How will you measure your progress? What adjustments do you need to make to help you achieve your goals?" "How does your learning from the related course come into play in your co-op experience, and what impact is your co-op experience having on your learning from the related course? How might these considerations affect your learning plan?" "How might some of the goals you set be modified to help you succeed at school, at work, or in other areas of your life?" "You have achieved many of your short-term goals. How has your experience so far influenced your thinking about your long-term goals?" "How can the feedback you receive from your placement supervisor and your teacher assist you in revising your learning plan?"

B2. Skills for the Future

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** identify and describe the skills and knowledge they have developed through their cooperative education experience (*e.g., critical thinking, problem-solving, creative and entrepreneurial thinking, time-management, technical, communication, and interpersonal skills; knowledge specific to the organization or sector; knowledge related to health, safety, and well-being, roles and responsibilities of workers, planning for their postsecondary endeavours; understanding of personal interests, strengths, and habits of mind*), as well as how their cooperative education experience extended or enhanced the skills and knowledge gained in their related course (*e.g., contributed to their growing mastery of skills developed in the related course; provided new insights into and perspectives on knowledge acquired in their related course; exposed them to real-life applications of what they learned in the related course, and to practical realities associated with that learning*)

Teacher prompts: "Describe how you developed technical and safety skills throughout your co-op experience." "How did you refine what you learned in your related course? How did your co-op experience support your learning from the related course?" "In your related course

you developed an awareness of how art can reflect the society in which it was created. How did understanding this prepare you for your co-op experience? In what ways did your co-op experience affect your perspective on what you learned [or: what you are currently learning] in your related course?" "Professional and ethical standards and policies pertaining to confidentiality, privacy, and acceptable use of technology are important to many different industry sectors and are part of responsible digital citizenship. As part of your related course, you developed an awareness of these standards and policies pertaining to the industry sector. Explain why these policies are important, how they can protect people, why they were created, and how they may have evolved over time. What have you learned about such standards and/or policies in your co-op placement?" "When you handled hazardous materials during your co-op experience, you were careful to apply what you learned about WHMIS in your related course and in your cooperative education course before beginning your placement. On reflection, do you think this practice has now become a habit of mind, something that is second nature to you? Can you identify when and how this shift came about?"

- B2.2** demonstrate how they are using skills and knowledge related to education and career/life planning in connection with their cooperative education experience (*e.g., reflecting on the education and career/life planning inquiry questions – Who am I? What are my opportunities? Who do I want to become? What is my plan for achieving my goals? – as they progress through the experience, and incorporating their insights in their Individual Pathways Plan*)

Teacher prompts: "You have spent some time identifying and understanding factors and experiences that have shaped who you are. Which of these factors or experiences are relevant to your co-op experience?" "How has participating in co-op expanded your awareness of postsecondary opportunities?" "Your co-op experience, along with what you learned in your related course, might have provided some insights into the demands and rewards of careers in that sector. Reflect on the fit between the realities of the work and who you want to become." "Reflect on the goals you set in your Individual Pathways Plan and your Student's Cooperative Education Learning Plan. Based on what you've learned in your co-op experience

and the related course, what kinds of financial and emotional support do you think you will need to achieve your goals? What other types of support might you need?" "Career-related decision making is often fluid and unpredictable, and rarely linear. How do you think the learning from your related course, and your co-op experience to date, might influence how you navigate the path through school to your initial postsecondary destination and beyond?"

- B2.3** describe how they might use the skills and knowledge developed through their cooperative education experience and their related course in other aspects of their lives, now and in the future (*e.g., in their education, training, workplace, or community living experiences; in their volunteer activities and hobbies; in their lives at home or within various communities, including online communities*)

Teacher prompts: "Reflect on the skills and knowledge that you have developed through the cooperative education experience and your related course and document this learning in your Individualized Pathways Plan (IPP). Explain how this knowledge and these skills might assist you in other aspects of your life." "You worked on a team during your co-op experience and developed communication and time-management skills. You have also done group work in your related course. How can you use these skills in your volunteer work at your local friendship centre?" "How will you use the skills and knowledge gained from your international co-op experience to bring greater awareness of other cultures to your peers, family, and community?" "Drawing on some of the learning from your related course and working with your placement supervisor, you developed a business plan for your prototype. What are some financial questions you need to consider and what logistical supports might you need to further develop and market your product locally, nationally, internationally, and/or online?" "Reflecting on your service learning* experience, what insights would you say that you have gained into the realities and complexities of the community? How did you learn from the community and how did community members learn from you? How has this experience changed your perspective on the particular issue or situation you were trying to address? How can your experience support the design, implementation and evaluation of an initiative to address the issue?" "During your co-op experience, how do you think you were

* *Service learning* is an experiential learning opportunity with a focus on service in the community – specifically, on addressing a need within a community or group. Service learning is intended to benefit both the provider and the recipient of the service.

perceived by your co-workers? By clients/ customers? What makes you think that? In what way might knowing how others perceive you help to inform your actions now and in the future?" "You explained that your experience taught you the value of perseverance. In what other aspects of your life might this habit of mind help you achieve your goals?" "You have achieved your goal of increasing your confidence in your customer-service abilities. How might you put this new sense of confidence to work in your other courses at school?" "What aspects of your co-op experience seem most likely to help you in dealing with situations that might arise at school or in the community in the future?"